



usually costlier than the Linux ones so if you're not working on .NET or any other Windows-based technology then you should go for a Linux based system. Another thing to point out is that if you're going for PaaS then the provider may not have execution environments for all programming languages eg. Rackspace Cloud Sites cannot run Java as of now. You'll have to verify whether your provider supports your programming language and which versions and libraries are made available as your entire application will be dependent on a specific version will be available. This won't be much of an issue if you're running your own instances as you'll be in the drivers seat and will be in full control of the entire software stack.

Budget

All these services are made available to you as utilities and like all other utilities you are charged based on what you consume, but with autoscaling and

other features you may land up with a large bill due to spikes in usage. For IaaS services you're usually charged per hour, i.e. how long your instance runs and for PaaS you're charged per month with limits on the underlying hardware and auto scaling so you'll be charged if your software exceeds the selected packages constraints. You'll have to carefully select the plan and instance sizes so that you meet your requirements and stay within the budget. A good place to start is cloudorado.com which is an IaaS comparison engine which lists prices from all different providers for a given configuration.

Migration

As such there is no vendor lock in as far as the providers are concerned. They provide you with an instance that you can control in case of an IaaS and a standard runtime in case of PaaS, so moving the applications is as good as shifting the executable to a different machine and reconfiguring it. The

only problem that one can face in moving from one provider to another is the hardware capabilities for IaaS and software/library versions in case of PaaS. Each provider calculates their computing units differently so you may see an increase or decrease in price moving from one provider to another. For PaaS the problem may arise with library or version incompatibility, you'll have to make sure that the libraries and execution environment can be replicated on the provider to which you're migrating.

Summing it up

We hope you find this article helpful in selecting the right cloud provider. We would like to reiterate that this article was just to point you in the correct direction, you'll still have to carefully scrutinize the details of the services offered by these providers but this article will help you to look for the right things. As is the case with most buying decisions, every problem has a unique solution.

The Silver Lining



According to an IDC survey on cloud computing and its effect on IT organizations and services, the demand for professional with a hands-on experience with cloud technologies will increase by 26 percent annually until 2014 and will lead to creation of more than seven million jobs related to cloud computing across the world with Asia-Pacific regions growing the fastest 32 percent annually resulting in more than 2.3 million cloud-related jobs by the end of 2015 in this region alone. In fact the job that require cloud-savvy IT pros is already on the rise, the problems that organizations are facing



Reach for the sky

right now is of skilled manpower, there are very few candidates that fit the bill.

Similarly, according to a KPMG survey, nearly two-thirds of firms around the are planning to or are currently using cloud technologies. On the other hand, according to a study by RightScale, 77 percent of respondents from various verticals across the industry plan to include a private cloud option as a part of their private cloud portfolios. All in all these reports signal a lot of interesting and exciting new job opportunities lie ahead.

Industry requirements

The industry is currently looking for people with requisite into categories: